Day 5 - Bert Lowe

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Niagara section · hike 7 · Old Welland Canal, St. Catharines

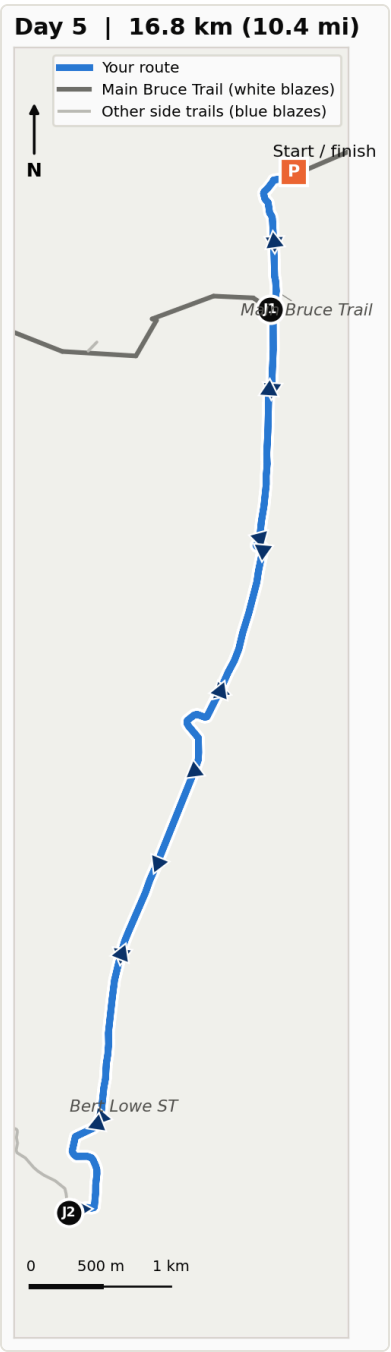
16.8 km / 10.4 mi	~4.8 h	4.0 km new	79 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

Park (P): Off Road Parking: On the north side of Glendale Ave, 50 m east of Welland Canal. Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day05_hike007.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Bert Lowe Side Trail (4.0 km)

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Off-road parking on the north side of Glendale Ave, 50 m east of the Welland Canal. No fee or capacity details were found.
- **Main Bruce Trail, road sections:** Around Glendale the main trail goes through urban St. Catharines. It uses road shoulders and paved paths, and the route crosses the canal on a bridge. Keep Zappy close on these stretches.
- **Main Bruce Trail, Old Welland Canal:** Off-road, the main trail follows the Third Welland Canal (1887-1931) past its abandoned locks. The lock walls are high with a long drop, so keep away from the edges.
- **Bert Lowe Side Trail:** An out-and-back on this blue-blazed side trail, which starts from a road section of the main trail. We could not find a published description of its terrain or features.
- **Cautions:** Nearby on the main trail, signs mark property with sewage lagoons; stay on the marked route. In fall, bird-scaring devices make loud shotgun-like booms that may startle a dog.
- **Dogs:** Leashed dogs are welcome on the Bruce Trail and its side trails.

Parking options

No other official Bruce Trail parking lies within about 1 km of this route. If you need to stop early, turn back the way you came; the GPS track records what you covered, and the website shows what is left.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Off Road Parking: On the north side of Glendale Ave, 50 m east of Welland Canal. Walk about 90 m to the trail. Head west on the white-blazed main Bruce Trail. The next 0.2 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
0.5	0.3	Heads-up: The next 0.7 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
1.1	0.7	J1: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Bert Lowe Side Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
8.4	5.2	J2: Turnaround point. Turn around and retrace your steps.
15.7	9.7	J1: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.) The next 0.7 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
16.5	10.3	Heads-up: The next 0.2 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
16.8	10.4	Leave the trail and walk back to the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Vishwa Walking; details of the Bert Lowe Side Trail were not found.